

Digital Literacy Project Report

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Introduction

Digital literacy has become an essential skill in today's technology-driven world, where academic, professional, and personal activities are increasingly conducted online. This project was designed to explore different aspects of digital literacy through a series of practical tasks, each focusing on a specific area such as content creation, professional presence, communication, collaboration, and cybersecurity awareness. Instead of approaching these topics theoretically, the project emphasizes hands-on application using real tools and platforms. Through this process, I engaged with various digital environments, reflected on my learning, and developed a more structured understanding of responsible and effective online behavior. Overall, this project highlights the importance of not only using digital tools, but using them thoughtfully and with awareness.

Task 1 – Infographic Reflection

For this task, I used Canva to create a one-page infographic on digital literacy. The design focuses on presenting key ideas in a simple and visually engaging way. It covers what digital literacy means, useful digital tools for students, safe internet practices, and the importance of maintaining a professional online presence.

While designing the infographic, I aimed to keep the content concise and easy to understand rather than overcrowding it with information. One challenge I faced was balancing clarity with visual appeal—deciding how much information to include without making the design look cluttered. I found it interesting how design choices, such as layout, icons, and spacing, can significantly affect how information is perceived.

Overall, this task helped me understand that digital literacy is not just about knowledge, but also about how effectively that knowledge is communicated to others.

Task 2 – Digital Portfolio Reflection

For this task, I created and updated my profiles on GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. Each platform serves a different purpose in building a professional digital presence. GitHub is primarily used for showcasing projects and tracking coding progress, making it essential for demonstrating technical skills. LinkedIn acts as a professional networking platform where I can present my academic background, connect with peers and professionals, and explore internship opportunities. Kaggle is focused on data science and provides access to datasets, competitions, and practical problem-solving experiences.

Over the next four years, I plan to use GitHub to regularly upload projects and document my learning journey. On LinkedIn, I aim to build a strong network and share my progress and achievements. Through Kaggle, I hope to gradually develop my analytical and data-handling

skills by participating in beginner-friendly challenges. Together, these platforms will help me build both my technical profile and professional identity.

This task helped me take the first step from being just a learner to building a visible digital presence.

Task 3 – Platforms Reflection

For this task, I explored both a coding practice platform and a collaboration tool. I created my account on HackerRank for the first time and chose C++ as my primary language, since we are currently studying Object-Oriented Programming in C++. I wanted to use this as a way to reinforce what I am learning in class rather than treating it as something separate.

I completed a beginner-level problem that required reading three numbers from standard input and printing their sum. While the problem itself was simple, it helped me overcome a mindset I previously had—that I need to “know everything first” before attempting coding problems. Starting small and learning through practice felt much more effective. Earning my first badge was a small but meaningful milestone, and it motivated me to continue.

For the collaboration part, I used Google Forms to create a Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz. Instead of only focusing on definitions, I designed questions that encouraged practical thinking and real-life decision-making. The link for this form can be found in the README.

These platforms will be highly useful academically. HackerRank can help me build consistency in problem-solving, while Google Forms can be used for surveys, feedback collection, and collaborative academic work. Overall, this task helped me shift from passive learning to more active and practical engagement with digital tools.

Task 4 – Reflection on Digital Communication

A common issue caused by poor digital communication is sending unclear or unprofessional emails in academic or professional settings. For example, a student might send a message to a professor without a subject line, proper greeting, or clear explanation, which can lead to confusion or being ignored entirely. In some cases, this can result in missed opportunities, such as not receiving help or approval on time.

A small mistake in digital communication can have larger consequences than expected. Imagine a student rushing to email a professor at midnight: no subject line, no greeting—just “I need more time, will submit later.” The intention may not be disrespectful, but the lack of structure and tone makes the message seem careless. The professor, receiving dozens of emails, overlooks or ignores it, assuming it is not serious. The student, on the other hand, assumes the extension is granted and submits late, leading to unnecessary confusion and penalty.

This situation could have been avoided with simple email etiquette—using a clear subject line, a polite greeting, and a concise explanation of the request. Digital communication is not just sending a message, but also ensuring it is understood correctly. A few extra seconds of thought can prevent avoidable problems.

Being concise yet complete in communication ensures that the recipient understands the purpose of the email and can respond effectively. Overall, good digital communication reflects professionalism and respect for others' time.

Social Media Do's and Don'ts

Do's

- Think before posting anything online
- Verify information before sharing
- Maintain a respectful and polite tone
- Protect your personal information
- Use social media for learning and networking

Don'ts

- Do not share sensitive information (OTP, passwords, address)
- Do not spread misinformation or unverified news
- Do not engage in online harassment or arguments
- Do not post impulsively when emotional
- Do not overshare personal life details publicly

Task 5 – Reflection on Cyber Awareness

What surprised me most while exploring phishing was how simple the attacks actually are. They do not rely on advanced hacking, but on small psychological tricks like urgency, trust, and curiosity. This makes them more dangerous, as anyone can fall for them without realizing it.

While working on this topic, I also reflected on an interactive phishing awareness project I had previously created. It made me realize how easily people can make incorrect decisions when presented with realistic scenarios.

As a result, one habit I will consciously change is slowing down before clicking on any link or responding to unexpected messages. Taking a few extra seconds to verify the source can prevent serious consequences. This task reinforced that digital safety is less about technical knowledge and more about awareness and mindful behavior.

Conclusion

This project helped me understand that digital literacy is not just about using tools, but about using them thoughtfully and responsibly. Through each task, I explored different aspects—from creating content and building a professional presence to practicing coding and understanding online risks. What stood out to me was how small actions, such as verifying a link or structuring an email properly, can make a significant difference. This experience also encouraged me to take initiative, whether by starting on platforms like GitHub or creating my own phishing awareness project. Overall, I now approach digital spaces with more awareness, intention, and confidence.

References

- Canva – for infographic creation
- GitHub – for project repository and profile
- LinkedIn – for professional profile
- Kaggle – for data science platform exploration
- HackerRank – for coding practice
- Google Forms – for quiz creation
- National Cyber Crime Portal: <https://www.cybercrime.gov.in>
- Cyber Crime Helpline: 1930